COMP4153 Natural Language Processing – Coursework 1 Marking Rubric

Criterion	Weight	<50	50–59	60–69	70–79	>80
1. Title, Abstract and Introduction	**10%**	Title/abstract are missing or substantially inaccurate. The NLP problem is unclear, poorly scoped or weakly motivated. Research question/objective and contribution are absent or inappropriate.	A recognisable NLP problem and basic motivation are provided, but the research question, scope or contribution is broad, imprecise or weakly justified. The abstract gives only a partial summary of the study.	Clear title, abstract and introduction. The research problem, motivation, scope and research question/objective are appropriate, and the main contribution is stated. The abstract summarises the principal elements of the work, although framing or precision could be stronger.	Focused and convincing research framing. The abstract accurately captures the problem, datasets, comparison methods, proposed contribution, principal findings and conclusion. The introduction establishes the importance of the problem, a precise research question/objective and a clear substantive contribution at a strong research-paper standard.	Exceptional research framing and academic communication. The problem is important, precisely defined and compellingly motivated; the abstract is concise and publication-quality; and the introduction articulates a significant contribution with the clarity, focus and positioning expected in a strong publishable study.
2. Related Work and Research Gap	**10%**	The review is very limited, substantially irrelevant or inaccurate. Important literature is missing or misunderstood, sources are weak, and the discussion is largely disconnected from the research problem. No credible research gap or positioning is established.	Relevant literature is identified, but coverage is narrow, uneven or mainly descriptive. Some important approaches or relationships between studies are omitted. Critical comparison is limited and the claimed research gap or motivation is only partly supported.	A suitable range of relevant and sufficiently recent literature is reviewed. The discussion demonstrates reasonable understanding of the principal approaches, methodological differences, strengths and limitations. Sources are generally appropriate, and a plausible research gap or unresolved issue is identified and linked to the proposed work.	Strong and well-organised critical synthesis of relevant literature. Representative approaches and findings are compared rather than merely listed, authoritative sources are used appropriately, and the review clearly explains the state of the field. A well-supported research gap or unresolved issue convincingly motivates and positions the student's proposed approach/model and contribution.	Exceptional scholarly synthesis demonstrating excellent command of the relevant literature. The review is selective yet comprehensive for the research question, integrates authoritative and recent work critically and precisely, exposes important methodological relationships and limitations, and establishes a compelling research gap and research positioning at a potentially publishable standard.
3. Proposed Method and Own Contribution	**30%**	No meaningful proposed approach/model is presented, or the claimed contribution is essentially a routine change such as model size, checkpoint, prompt wording or hyperparameter adjustment. The approach is technically unsound, unclear or not meaningfully distinguished from existing work.	A proposed approach/model and some own contribution are identifiable, but the contribution is minor, weakly motivated or only partly developed. Technical description is incomplete and the connection between the design, research problem and identified gap is weak.	A meaningful and technically sound proposed approach/model is clearly described and motivated. The student's own contribution is identifiable and distinguishable from existing work, with appropriate technical explanation. The work demonstrates independent thinking, although the significance or methodological depth of the contribution remains moderate.	A clear, non-trivial and substantive own contribution is convincingly distinguished from existing approaches. The proposed approach/model is technically well designed, strongly motivated by the research problem and literature, and explained rigorously using suitable figures, algorithms and/or mathematical formulation. The contribution and methodological reasoning are of a strong research-paper standard.	Exceptional research contribution with excellent technical design and compelling justification. The proposed approach/model provides a significant insight, methodological contribution or well-founded integration beyond routine modification, is positioned precisely against prior work, and is described with the maturity and depth expected of a potentially publishable study.
4. Datasets, Experimental Setup and Baseline Implementation	**20%**	Fewer than two appropriate datasets or fewer than five existing methods are used, major implementation/experimental errors are present, or the protocol is seriously unfair or insufficiently described. Results cannot be trusted or reproduced.	Two datasets and at least five methods are attempted, but dataset choice, implementation, preprocessing, splits, metrics or settings contain notable weaknesses. Important details or citations are missing and comparability/reproducibility is limited.	Two suitable public datasets are clearly described and at least five existing methods are correctly implemented/adapted and evaluated on both datasets. Preprocessing, splits, metrics and main settings are technically sound and mostly consistent, with appropriate citation of external resources.	Rigorous and well-justified experimental design and implementation. At least five methods are faithfully reproduced or carefully adapted on both datasets, experimental settings are consistently applied, and important implementation choices, seeds, repeated runs and computational constraints are transparently documented. The protocol supports fair and reproducible comparison.	Exceptional technical execution and experimental design. Dataset choice, baseline implementation and evaluation protocol are robust, transparent and carefully controlled. Confounding factors, uncertainty, computational constraints and reproducibility are handled with excellent judgement at a standard suitable for supporting publishable conclusions.
5. Results, Quantitative/Qualitative Analysis and Discussion	**20%**	Results are missing, incorrect, incomplete or poorly presented. The proposed approach/model is inadequately compared with baselines. Analysis is largely descriptive, qualitative evidence is absent where needed, and error/ablation analysis is missing or invalid.	Basic quantitative results are presented, but comparison or interpretation is limited. Qualitative examples, error analysis or ablation/component analysis are superficial or incomplete. Discussion tends to restate performance numbers rather than explain behaviour, limitations or trade-offs.	Results clearly compare at least five existing methods and the proposed approach/model across both datasets. Appropriate quantitative metrics and useful qualitative examples are presented. Discussion provides sensible interpretation of performance differences, and error/ablation analysis gives reasonable evidence about the proposed contribution.	Rigorous quantitative and qualitative analysis. Results are clearly organised and interpreted using appropriate metrics and uncertainty/repeated-run evidence where relevant. Informative qualitative examples, error analysis and well-designed ablation/controlled experiments explain what the proposed contribution adds, where it succeeds/fails and why. Discussion connects findings to the research question and literature and avoids unsupported claims.	Exceptional analysis producing deep, well-supported and potentially novel insights. Quantitative evidence, qualitative diagnostics, error analysis and comprehensive ablation/control experiments are integrated effectively to explain behaviour, generalisation, limitations and trade-offs. Claims are precise and carefully bounded by the evidence, at a level expected in a potentially publishable paper.

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6. Conclusion, References and Reproducibility	**10%**	Conclusion is missing or unsupported, references are inadequate/inaccurate, or code/appendix evidence is missing or inconsistent with the paper. The work is poorly organised and not reproducible.	A basic conclusion and references are provided, but limitations/future work, citation quality or reproducibility are incomplete. Code reproduces only part of the work or requires substantial manual correction; traceability to reported results is weak.	Conclusion appropriately summarises the main findings, limitations and future work. References and external resources are generally accurate. Submitted notebooks and appendix evidence reproduce the main experiments with only minor omissions, and the paper is coherent and appropriately presented.	Strong evidence-based conclusion that directly answers the research question and treats limitations maturely. References are accurate and complete. Code, appendix evidence and paper are consistent and sufficiently documented for independent verification of the main results. Presentation is professional and at a strong research-paper standard.	Exceptional synthesis, reproducibility and presentation. Conclusions are precise and mature, references are publication-quality, and the research artefacts are carefully organised and straightforward to independently reproduce. The complete paper and experimental package demonstrate the professionalism expected of a potentially publishable study.
Total	**100%**					